

Widowed Persons

Table 9.6 shows the percentage of female and male aged 15 years and over who reported their marital status as "widowed" in the 1981, 2012, and 2024 Censuses.

Table 9.6 : Percentage of Widowed Population Aged 15 Years and over, 1981, 2012, and 2024

Age Group (Years)	Percentage of Widowed Persons					
	Male			Female		
	1981	2012	2024	1981	2012	2024
Population 15 years and over	1.2	1.3	2.1	5.2	8.7	11.7
15-19	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.0
20-24	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.5	0.2	0.1
25-29	0.2	0.1	0.1	1.1	0.5	0.3
30-34	0.3	0.1	0.2	2.0	1.0	0.7
35-39	0.6	0.2	0.3	3.9	1.9	1.3
40-44	1.0	0.4	0.4	7.0	3.5	2.5
45-49	1.8	0.6	0.7	11.1	6.2	4.7
50-54	2.9	1.1	1.2	16.4	10.0	8.3
55-59	4.2	1.8	2.1	22.8	14.8	14.2
60-64	6.5	3.0	3.6	31.4	21.2	21.7
65 and over	13.3	8.6	10.5	47.7	38.4	44.2

As shown in Table 9.6, the incidence of widowhood increases with age. Among females aged 65 years and over, the percentage of widowed is as high as 44.2 percent, whereas the percentage of widowed males in the same age group is 10.5 percent. Furthermore, in every age group, the percentage of widowed females is higher than that of widowed males.

Divorced Persons/ Persons Separated from Spouse

Table 9.7 presents the number of divorced or separated persons per 10,000 population aged 15 years and over for the census years 1981, 2012, and 2024.

Table 9.7 : Number of Divorced or Separated Persons per 10,000 Population Aged 15 Years and Over, 1981, 2012, and 2024

Marital Status		1981		2012		2024	
		Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female
Divorced		23	37	20	33	35	50
Separated	Legal	19	26	15	25	21	31
	Not legal	*	*	59	88	79	112

*No data were collected under "Separated (not legally)" in the 1981 Census

Divorce rate 2024 (per 10,000 persons) for both males and females have increased compared to 1981 and 2012. The rates are reported as 35 for males and 50 for females. Also, separations have increased. Non-legal separations showing a notable rise among both males and females by 2024. This is observed at a rate of 79 males and 112 females per 10,000 persons, respectively.